



PROGRESS REPORT

Digital divides: progress report, 2025-09-01 to 2026-09-06

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48 countries. Each row below is carried verbatim from that country's own progress report, which answers a fixed frame of indicators over the period; nothing is written here. A country not listed under an indicator has **No evidence** on it in its own report.

Progress values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, regulations still pending*.

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Bridging of digital divides

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Algeria	A universal-service programme reached 1,400 low-density areas in its first phase, with no target, budget or completion date. Full record The programme's position was not held at the window's opening. By May 2026 it had reached 1,400 areas in a first phase, with no target, budget or completion date stated, against 76.9% internet penetration and 10.9m people offline in 2025. The offline figure is a third-party compilation rather than an official series, and no rural coverage, affordability or usage-gap measure is published by the regulator or the ministry. So the country can state how many areas a programme reached and not how many people remain outside it, except on someone else's number.	Advanced
Angola	Satellite programmes reached six universities and more than 300 localities without mobile operators, while the universal service fund has published no accounts, grant or disbursement. Full record 2026-07-13 — the connectivity programme is stated at six universities and more than 300 localities where mobile operators are absent, with 20,000 students, against 27 locations and about 366,000 citizens stated to a United Nations body in November 2025. The counts are not the same measure and the base cannot net them; a separate white-space leg connected 3,972 students at two schools. Alongside it, a commercial access hub opened in December 2025 with 37 firms in the integration process by April 2026, and a first startup was licensed to resell satellite access in July 2026. The instrument built for this has done nothing on the record. The universal service fund and its 1% levy on telecom operators' gross revenue remain on statute, it may make non-repayable grants for non-commercial universal-service expansion and is barred from subsidising operating costs, and no accounts, grant or disbursement have been published for any year since 2010.	Mixed, satellite connectivity reaching new places while the universal service fund has published nothing in sixteen years

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Benin	At least 75% of identification services were accessed digitally in 2025, while the regulator's usage report carries no disaggregation by gender or rurality. Full record 2026-02-02 — at least 75% of identification services were accessed digitally in 2025, with the unconnected served by an unstructured-menu channel and by in-person windows. That is the clearest adoption figure on this ledger and it is about one service family. 2026-05-19 — the regulator's 2025 report records rising digital usage alongside the mobile-money figures, with no disaggregation by gender or rurality in the account held. So use is rising and nobody has published who is left out. The one intervention that reached the excluded directly was a charity's card distribution, reported under registration of the population, and it worked because it went to nine communes in person.	Advanced, with the divide itself unmeasured
Botswana	The universal fund handed over two school digital centres at P1.45m and P1.5m per site, while the single community wireless site has had no successor in fourteen months. Full record A two-day multistakeholder workshop in Gaborone mapped the creative industries to shape a more inclusive digital future (workshop). 2026-07-22 — two school digital centres were handed over in one district at P1.45m and P1.5m per site, thirty machines each, the second framed as addressing the rural divide. The fund is a 1% levy on mobile service providers, no programme total or school target is published, and the base carried nothing on its school programme before January 2026. Against that, the community wireless site launched in June 2025 with tariffs of P2 to P10 and a free 45-minute daily window remains the only one, with no second site recorded in fourteen months. Two laboratories and one hotspot is the whole of the published inclusion delivery, against an unresolved dispute about what the national penetration rate even is, reported under internet usage.	Advanced
Burkina Faso	White-zone equipment is ordered for delivery before end-2026, while real fourth-generation coverage fell from 53% to 33% and access runs 72% urban against 27% rural. Full record 2026-04-04 — service orders were signed and equipment ordered for the first white-zone tranche, most localities identified, with delivery targeted before end-2026, against a tender dossier for 750 localities finalised and the project not yet launched; a second lot of 750 localities was announced for 2027 with no separate financing line. The zero-white-zone-by-2027 framing sits against a 2030 horizon for full coverage of about 2,000 zones. The universal access fund co-finances half the state's FCFA 37.5bn white-zone contribution, levied at 2% of operator turnover, with no fund account published for any year from 2024 to 2026. Against the build, real fourth-generation coverage fell from 53% to 33% on insecurity, on a figure whose earlier reading no held source dates. Internet access stands at about 72% urban against about 27% rural, not repeated or disaggregated by gender anywhere, and the only household survey instrument the base names dates from 2013. One donor project closed: a 2021 to 2026 Sahel connectivity project serving more than 3,650 users including refugees published its report, with US\$1.2m from one European state, on a pledge made in January 2025.	Mixed, a white-zone programme moved into delivery while real coverage fell from 53% to 33% on insecurity
Burundi	The broadband programme targets 80% territorial coverage and carries a digital villages component, with no achieved figure on file. Full record 2026-05-01 — the broadband programme is stated to target 80% of the territory, with a digital villages component under way and no completion date or coverage achieved on file. No baseline was held for either. What is measurable sits elsewhere in this report and cuts the other way: tariffs more than doubled, the satellite alternative costs more than most can pay, and the regulator says the network fails mainly on electricity. A territorial coverage target says where a signal reaches; none of the three says whether anyone can afford or rely on it.	Advanced, on a target rather than on an achieved figure

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Cameroon	A FCFA 55bn rural component targeting 328 unserved localities by 2028 went to tender, with no award on file. Full record 2025-11-09 - a limited national tender opened for the rural component of the national connectivity project: FCFA 55bn, 328 unserved localities targeted by 2028 in two phases of 120 sites plus an optional 208, with works expected by 30 December 2026. No award, contract or site count is held after the tender opened. The domestic mechanism that would otherwise fund this is gone: the Special Telecommunications Development Fund stays abolished and universal-service money is not separately traceable in FY2024, FY2025 or FY2026, so rural connectivity now runs through donor projects rather than a domestic account.	Advanced, on a tender with no award held, against a universal-service fund abolished before the window
Cape Verde	The universal service fund is appropriated at CVE 122,073,633 for FY2026, identical to the escudo across three budgets. Full record The fund is financed from operator contributions and the radio-spectrum fee, carried in the earmarked-revenue table and in no organic, functional or economic classification, and is appropriated at CVE 122,073,633 for FY2026, identical to the escudo across FY2024, FY2025 and FY2026 - a fee-financed ceiling rolled forward rather than re-estimated. The base holds the appropriation only: no expenditure, project, governing instrument or annual report for the fund from any date. So the one instrument the country has for connecting what the market will not connect cannot be shown to have spent anything.	No change
Central African Republic	The country's first free public access point was inaugurated in April 2026, while the universal service fund is still not operational, with implementation targeted for 2026. Full record 2026-04-24 – the President inaugurated what is presented as the country's first free public internet access point, with technical support from Russian cooperation. It is one site with no bandwidth, uptime, user or funding figure, carried by a pro-government outlet, and the item doubles as campaign copy for a local legislative candidate. The fund that should be doing this work has never operated. The levy was provided for by a 2018 law and a February 2019 decree, its supervising committee's activities launched in July 2025, and effective implementation is named among the regulator's 2026 priorities; it is financed by a 2% levy on operators' previous-year turnover, with scope covering broadband in schools, health centres, town halls, libraries and post offices. It has never published an amount collected, a balance or an allocation in the seven years since the levy took effect, and no collection figure, project award or operator selection is held.	Advanced, one public access point opened while the universal service fund reached its eighth year without operating
Comoros	Five mobile science caravans covering about ninety rural localities a year are being launched under the technology park pilot. Full record The caravans were announced on 24 January 2026 as five mobile units covering about ninety rural localities a year and described as being launched at the technology park pilot five days later, with no caravan count, route or start date confirmed since. They are the only named rural digital-divide instrument in the base. No universal service or rural access fund exists for this country, no rural coverage figure is published, and the measurement body that would report one was never created.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Congo	20 of 76 rural sites are fully operational, against almost 80% of the rural population outside fourth-generation coverage. Full record 2025-10 - the ministry reported 20 of 76 built-and-equipped sites fully operational at a mid-term review, with 56 in advanced stages, an additional US\$3m allocated to upgrade sites to fourth-generation service and 16 rural localities across six departments commissioned. No later site count is held, so the position has not been restated in ten months and whether the end-2025 target was met is unestablished. The universal fund was appropriated at FCFA 1,000,000,000 for 2026, its first figure on file, flat for three consecutive years and spent entirely as transfers, and two further towns were connected in January 2026 against 2025 targets of ten multimedia centres and 100 connected sites whose achievement is not established. Rural coverage stands at 33% for third-generation and 21% for fourth-generation service, with half the rural population outside any coverage. The US\$3,000,000 upgrade allocation is stated by the minister as the government's own, distinct from the project envelope, with the fiscal year unstated and no local-currency figure published.	Mixed, twenty rural sites came into service and two towns were connected while the 76-site end-2025 target has not been restated in ten months
Cote d'Ivoire	Territorial coverage rose to about 95% and the rural programme's first phase is stated complete, against a 575-locality target; the urban-rural gap stays unmeasured. Full record The universal-service agency put territorial coverage at 82% with about 500 localities being connected and now at about 95%, with 500 villages connected under the 2025 emergency programme and 300 more localities planned for 2026. Both figures are the agency's or ministry's own. The target was 575 localities and 825,675 residents by December 2025; no completion statement against it exists and the shortfall passes unremarked in every held account, including the thirty-town account of September 2025. A feature-phone service platform stated for launch by the end of the first quarter of 2026 has nothing on file establishing it happened. 2026-08-28 - the ministry states the first phase of the rural connectivity programme complete, commissioned at Djebakaha in Korhogo, with phases two and three launched alongside it, the second at FCFA 18bn covering 240 further localities across Belier, Poro, Tchologo, Bagoue and Haut-Sassandra against a 575-locality programme target. The account dates that commissioning to August 2024 while reporting it as current, so the phase chronology is not relied on; no site count or subscriber figure accompanies the completion.	Mixed, territorial coverage rose to about 95% while the rural connectivity programme missed its December 2025 target and a feature-phone platform did not launch
Djibouti	Digital houses were announced across five inland regions, 3,000 to be trained by 2029 at a stated EUR 7m; no site is open. Full record The initiative did not exist at the window's opening. 2026-05 - it was announced across five inland regions, with 3,000 to be trained by 2029 at a stated EUR 7m and no site open on record. Both figures are the programme's own. It is the only instrument on this ledger addressed to the interior. The domestic fibre programme has reached the interior one facility at a time - a regional hospital, then a school, sub-prefecture and clinic - and no rural coverage, penetration or affordability figure exists for the country at any date.	Advanced

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DR Congo	The fund signed subsidy conventions with four operators for 40 localities, against about 4.3m people with no mobile coverage. Full record The fund was created by law in November 2020 and, per a named civil-society officer, still not available at the window's opening. 2026-08-08 - it signed subsidy conventions with the four operators for a first tranche of 40 localities covering about 258,000 people, with a second phase of 300 sites and a 2030 target of 3,000 localities and 16m people; passive infrastructure stands at fewer than 5,500 towers against an estimated need of at least 30,000. The phase-0 sites were operator-nominated, ten each, rather than scored on the fund's published index. A national diagnostic finds about 4.3 million people in nearly 3,000 localities without mobile coverage, national 2G coverage 77%, 3G 68% and 4G 57%, from about 98% in Kinshasa to 14% in Tshuapa. And a rural solar base-station commitment of up to 2,000 sites was restated sixteen months on with no sites-built count.	Mixed, the universal service fund signed its first subsidy conventions while about 4.3 million people remain uncovered and eastern territories were cut off entirely
Egypt	The rural fibre programme reached more than 1,250 of 1,450 first-phase villages and about 5 million fibre lines. Full record The programme stood at 856 of 1,450 first-phase villages connected at end-2024, up from 267 at end-2023. 2026-06-30 - it reached more than 1,250 of 1,450 first-phase villages across 52 markazes in 20 governorates, about 5 million fibre lines and 75% of village service complexes connected, the programme being carried into a deepened lender partnership. No completion date for the remaining 200 villages is stated in any held source, and a 2024 account gives a much larger village frame which the base does not reconcile with the first-phase denominator - so the share of rural Egypt reached depends on which denominator is used, and nothing on file settles it.	Advanced
Equatorial Guinea	Twenty of 34 planned towers were live on the mainland trunk road by September 2025. Full record Coverage is being extended along the mainland interior corridor: twenty of 34 planned towers live on the Bata-Mongomo road by September 2025, with the remainder inside the 85 per cent coverage target for end-2026. The divide that is not closing is electrical: rural electrification near 2 per cent against 90 per cent urban, and a mainland district at 2.4 per cent grid access.	Advanced
Eswatini	A second community innovation hub opened in August 2026, against a stated 58 per cent internet-usage rate and 56 per cent youth unemployment. Full record The second hub opened in a rural region (hub, phase). It opened against a stated 58 per cent internet-usage rate and 56 per cent youth unemployment, and the account is the funding agency's own (opening). No financing figure was disclosed for the facility, and no user, training or enterprise-support count is published for either hub (hubs). Two hubs are the country's whole physical inclusion programme.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Ethiopia	A 1.5% revenue levy funds universal access, and handset financing targets up to two million smartphones a year. Full record From March 2026 both operators contribute 1.5% of revenue to a universal access fund, about 2.5bn birr a year (access fund levy). Financing deals with two banks target up to two million handsets a year for low-income customers on long-term instalments (handset financing). A telco-agnostic wallet launched in December 2025 works on a subscriber module from any network and is verified against the national identity, removing network lock-in (the wallet). Nothing is published on what the access fund has disbursed, on how many handsets have been financed, or on the gap either is meant to close.	Advanced
Gabon	Zero-roaming and fibre agreements were signed with Equatorial Guinea in November 2025. Full record The ceremony at Ciudad de La Paz produced three instruments signed by both ministers with their national regulators and operators as principals: zero roaming, spectrum interference coordination and a fibre link. They address the border rather than the interior. No Gabonese coverage, price or usage figure accompanies them.	Advanced
Gambia	D75 per gigabyte from January 2026 with the floor price gone, against 45.9 per cent internet use. Full record Price moved by order: the tariff decision effective 1 January 2026 sets mobile data at D75 per gigabyte, ends the regulated floor and introduces rollover, on a ministerial directive of 16 October 2025 with the cost-of-service study still pending. Use is the constraint the price is meant to shift: 1.30m internet users, 45.9 per cent of the population against 3.19m mobile connections. Targeted programmes are small and specific — digital skills for women-owned small firms from October 2025.	Advanced
Ghana	The universal access fund is slated for conversion into a wider development fund, with its rural telephony project still stated as top priority. Full record The fund still operates and the base holds no levy receipts, accounts or disbursement figure at any date (fund). A draft bill under legislative review would convert it into a digital-infrastructure, innovation and skills fund, with levy rate, governance structure and the fate of the rural-access earmark all unestablished and the draft text unpublished (conversion bill). The rural telephony project runs on a EUR 140.8m buyer's credit signed in May 2020 and has taken an upgraded mast design (credit); the last disbursement figure held is 60.2 per cent as at May 2022, with no site count, coverage figure or completion date (credit). No community network regime exists; the regulator says an existing hotspot authorisation could found one, and its register shows four such authorisations each capped at three districts (community networks, access gaps). American-funded inclusion and connectivity programming slowed or stopped after the 2025 wind-down with no replacement funder named (withdrawal).	Mixed, the access fund is slated for conversion while its flagship project runs on and donor programming was withdrawn
Guinea	Guinea is one of five states whose second submarine cable bids were evaluated at Abuja in July 2026. Full record The evaluation committee meeting of 29 June to 10 July 2026 covers five member states under the regional digital programme, Guinea among them, and assesses bids for capacity on a second West African submarine cable. Domestically, the financing that reaches administrations outside the capital is the US\$81m local governance credit whose component split was confirmed in June 2025.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Guinea-Bissau	A 2026-2031 universal access fund plan sets targets for closing the coverage gap. Full record The instrument was found wanting first: a legal review recommended restructuring the universal access fund in October 2025. The 2026-2031 strategic and financing plan followed, and the network it would fund is still at tender: the fibre backbone relaunched in March 2026 after two cancelled rounds. Regionally, five states evaluated bids for a second submarine cable in Abuja in July 2026.	Advanced
Kenya	588 digital hub sites are committed against a target of one per ward, and smartphone connections passed 50m for the first time. Full record Forty-six centres of excellence and forty standard hubs are under construction, procurement of 10,000 locally assembled desktops is complete for the first 100 pilot hubs and a further 10,000 is in final stages (hubs); these are committed sites rather than completed hubs, unreconciled against the enablement programme's installed-base series. A separate plan for 100 county centres of excellence broke ground on its first at Kikuyu on 21 August 2026, with no budget, timetable or site list stated and no statement of how the two programmes relate (county hubs). The universal service fund connected 20 sub-locations in FY2024/25 and 155 cumulatively, reaching about 508,012 people, with construction started at 32 of 47 planned centres (fund); no FY2025/26 account is published, and no levy rate or fund balance is held (fund). A fund skilling project targets 120,000 people in 19 counties over three years, with no budget line, delivery partner, county list or start date published (skilling). Smartphone connections reached 50.2m in March 2026 with feature phones down to 28.5m (devices), while American-funded inclusion programming slowed or stopped after the 2025 wind-down (withdrawal). The withdrawal is now visible at programme level: a women's digital-rights accelerator whose grant fell through when the agency pulled its money was continued by its partners without it, reaching three of an original ten counties while Kisumu did not proceed, a county government providing premises and recruitment in place of the funding (accelerator). Internet use stands at 35.0 per cent, men 37.8 to women 32.2 on the 2023/24 housing survey.	Mixed, hub programmes expanded while the fund's own delivery account stopped and donor programming withdrew
Lesotho	245 of more than 1,800 mapped schools are connected, and the community inclusion model passed to the universal service fund. Full record 2025-11-19 – a ministerial statement reports 245 of more than 1,800 mapped schools connected under the schools connectivity programme, alongside universal-fund community digital centres. 2025-11-20 – the community digital inclusion model moved from a development-agency pilot to full universal service fund management. 2026-07-01 – the regulator's three-year plan makes universal and meaningful connectivity its top theme. The ministry put broadband coverage at 100% against about 50% regular internet use, so the divide these programmes address is one of use rather than reach.	Advanced
Liberia	Satellite connectivity in Vahun District and a new 4G tower in Maryland County reached previously unserved communities. Full record The Universal Access Fund installed satellite connectivity in Vahun District, Lofa County, a completed deployment rather than an intention, though no cost or subscriber figure is given. Separately an operator opened a 4G tower in Karluway District, Maryland County, bringing mobile and internet service to Karloken City and Wutuken Township where coverage had been limited or absent; this is commercial expansion, not a fund project, and carries no coverage figure. Liberia's first Digital Village opened in Lofa County in May 2026 with connectivity and skills training, on no published instrument.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Libya	Household internet at 92 per cent, with off-grid solar and university networks extending reach. Full record The household survey puts household internet at 92 per cent and internet use among women at 74 per cent, which is high for the region and leaves the divide sitting elsewhere than access to a connection. Where the state is closing gaps it is doing so through power and campus networks: 400 off-grid solar systems for remote clusters and border posts, grid work for a settlement cut off since 1999, and a university completing the second phase of its unified fibre network.	Advanced
Madagascar	An affordable-device facility approved nine applications and made a US\$2.5m first call, and 664,000 devices had been distributed by June 2026. Full record The facility is a US\$24m sub-component of the connectivity project: an April 2025 call closed with nothing contracted, and by November 2025 nine applications were approved with only two operator contracts unsigned, a US\$2.5m first call for funds made on 7 November and a student-laptop pilot proposed for about 700 computers (facility). The June 2026 portfolio review records 664,000 devices distributed, against a rural-connectivity tender document that slipped from October 2025 to January 2026 (review, supervision).	Advanced
Malawi	A national survey finds the gender gap in phone ownership virtually unchanged over a decade, while the Universal Service Fund is stated to be insufficiently resourced and 85 per cent of schools have limited or no internet. Full record The fund runs a school connectivity project providing computer equipment and secondary-school skills work is stated to draw on it, but the Director General stated existing funding levels remain insufficient for the country's connectivity needs, and no income, balance or disbursement figure is held for any year (fund, skills). The regulator said in August 2026 it is evaluating fund mechanisms to subsidise consumer devices and fund digital-literacy work, including a proposed one-tablet-one-student programme (subsidies). Eighty-five per cent of the country's 9,000 schools have limited or no internet access and about 900 have none, with lack of electricity and devices the main barriers (schools, support). A December 2025 survey measures the divide the state does not: mobile-phone ownership at 66 per cent of adults, the gender gap virtually unchanged over a decade at 74 per cent of men against 57 per cent of women, and a quarter of adults owning a smartphone, with the shortfall falling hardest on rural residents, the less educated and the poor. It is a survey with a margin of two to three percentage points, not a state statistic; the state publishes none.	Mixed, a universal service fund evaluating device subsidies while its own resourcing is stated as insufficient
Mauritius	Rodrigues was brought into the national digital strategy in May 2026 through a cybersecurity framework, a youth project and post-office access to the national sign-on. Full record A ministerial mission to the island in May 2026 agreed a cybersecurity working framework with a mainland-based team and a dedicated representative, a youth awareness project, and integration of the national sign-on and super-app through post office agents, building on the regional assembly's own roadmap (mission). It is the first national digital commitment to the outer island on record. No connectivity, usage or service-uptake figure for it is published.	Advanced
Morocco	The only device-cost measure on file is an operator refurbishing 6,000 internet boxes in 2025, saving a reported EUR 1.5m. Full record An operator sustainability report published in July 2026 gives 6,000 boxes refurbished in Morocco during 2025 with EUR 1.5m in savings, company-reported (report). Only the group figure of 164,000 boxes across Africa and the Middle East carries a prior year (group figure), so the Moroccan number has no direction. No urban-rural, income or gender divide measure is held for the country.	No change, a first company-reported figure with no earlier year behind it

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Mozambique	Sixty rural mobile stations were awarded and 700,000 subsidised smartphones provided for, against 80 per cent urban penetration and 20 per cent rural. Full record Sixty mobile stations across nine provinces were awarded in October 2025, each with second and fourth-generation service, a public multimedia centre, solar power, a prepaid public telephone and a hundred handsets; the scope had doubled from thirty sites and no completion date is on record (award, tender). A programme provides for 700,000 subsidised smartphones starting at US\$5m and able to grow to US\$25m, financed through microcredit and pay-as-you-go models (smartphones); no start date, distribution channel or eligibility rule is published (smartphones). The regulator puts penetration at about 80 per cent urban against about 20 per cent rural (gap), and planned and running inclusion work slowed or stopped after a funder's 2025 wind-down with no replacement named (withdrawal).	Mixed, sixty new rural stations and a subsidy programme against an 80 to 20 urban-rural gap and a major funder's withdrawal
Namibia	Twenty-five towers entered service across nine regions, schools and clinics under new towers get seven years free internet, and 100 per cent coverage is targeted for 2030. Full record Twenty-five towers went into service across nine regions at N\$40m in total, about N\$1.6m each, built with the state fixed operator (towers). Schools and clinics under towers built in the previous two years get free internet for seven years, on N\$80m in nine radio access network towers over two years (free internet); no list or count of covered schools or clinics is published (free internet). The 2030 coverage target was set in June 2025 against about 360,000 people, roughly 12 per cent, outside 4G coverage at February 2024, with a parallel internet-use target of 53 to 90 per cent by 2030 (target, plan). Siting delays on communal land are the constraint the ministry names, and it met the traditional authorities' trust with the regulator and three operators in July 2026 with no agreement reported (siting). A stakeholder submission to the periodic review put internet penetration above 64 per cent in 2025 but rural household mobile internet access at 16.2 per cent and smartphone ownership below 30 per cent, naming affordability and low digital literacy as what holds access back, alongside a persistent gender gap in meaningful use (submission).	Advanced
Niger	A rural inclusion programme has one centre on record and a second community centre opened at Tahoua, while an analyst warns of systemic exclusion. Full record The rural programme opened a digital centre at Tabelot in Agadez with women's and girls' skills training, and one centre is all that is on record (programme, project). A second community digital centre was inaugurated at Tahoua in July 2026 with 100 computers and 50 kW of solar power, built by an international agency and donor-funded (centre). A named analyst warns of privacy breaches, state surveillance and systemic exclusion under the biometric identity programme, with rural communities, migrants and those without foundational identity most exposed (warning).	Mixed, two community digital centres and a rural programme against a warning that rural communities and those without foundational identity are most exposed

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Nigeria	23 per cent of rural communities have internet against 57 urban, zero-rated education access would require registration, and rural job centres are at equipment tender. Full record Rural internet reaches 23 per cent of communities against 57 per cent urban (rural); the universal service fund plans 1,000 new rural base stations by 2030 and the minister told the President that about 3,700 towers start deploying around October 2026 targeting more than 20m people in communities with no service at all, with capital raised and no funding source, operator or contract named (rural, stations, towers). Every eligibility option consulted on for zero-rated education access requires registration to control access and prevent abuse, the monitoring set includes tunnelling and streaming of non-educational content, and the regulator says on the record the scheme may breach net neutrality (zero rating). Equipment for rural job centres in two states is out to tender under a foreign-funded youth-employment project, fixing the equipment stage and nothing about the centres (centres); agent-network microfinance reaches microenterprises through trained local agents with no published coverage figures (microfinance).	Mixed, 3,700 towers contracted for unserved communities while only 23 per cent of rural communities have internet and zero-rating would require registration to use
Rwanda	Household internet reached 30 per cent in 2023-24 on a 56 to 19 urban and rural split, while the universal access fund's owed annual report is not held for any year. Full record The household living conditions survey for 2023-24 puts internet at home at 30 per cent of households nationally, against 17 per cent in 2016-17, with 56 per cent of urban households connected and 19 per cent of rural (survey, penetration). Among adults with disabilities, the share with no formal or informal financial access fell from 9.6 per cent in 2020 to 8.1 per cent in 2024 and non-bank formal access rose from 58.0 to 72.4 per cent, while the banked share slipped from 15.0 to 14.3 per cent (survey insights, coverage). The universal access order was gazetted on 15 May 2023, repealing the 2004 order. The fund has no separate legal personality and its staff sit inside the regulator, and the annual activity report owed to the regulatory board by 30 September is not held for any year (order, regulator). A smart-device affordability fund is at design stage with a market assessment pending (devices). The measured position improves while every instrument named to improve it is either unreported or at design stage.	Mixed, household connection and disability inclusion up while every named instrument is unreported
Sao Tome and Principe	The 2012 universal service decree defines the service's scope and its financing fund, and is the operative instrument; no disbursement or coverage obligation is held. Full record The decree defines the scope of the universal telecommunications service and establishes the price-setting and financing regimes applicable to it, and is the basis of the universal service fund (decree). The same gazette issue carries decrees on international call control and SIM card registration. Nothing held records a disbursement from the fund, a designated provider's obligations, or a coverage target set under it (decree). The copy is hosted by the regional regulators' association; no copy was located on a government site. What has reached under-served places instead is a satellite service (satellite) and the operator's own antenna programme (antenna).	No change
Senegal	The telecommunications minister put 40 per cent of the population without connectivity during the critical-infrastructure debate, on a 2024 diagnosis that is not held. Full record The figure was stated during the bill's debate and attributed to a 2024 sector diagnosis of coverage gaps and unmet operator obligations. The diagnosis itself is not held, no definition of access is given, and the figure is two years old at the point of its citation (gap). It sits against fourth-generation coverage reaching 97 per cent of the population in 2025 (coverage), so the two figures are measuring different things and no source reconciles them.	No change

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sierra Leone	Internet penetration is unchanged, and the gap the evidence points at is usage against investment rather than coverage. Full record A separate 2024 estimate is on file alongside the current figure; the definitions differ and both are kept dated rather than merged (penetration, estimate). The usage measure sets telecommunications investment against what is actually used; its price series is an attributed opposition critique rather than an official statistic (usage, critique). Backbone reaching 14 of 16 districts against a usage gap of this shape is the argument for device affordability and price over further build, and the only instrument aimed there is a private financing scheme with unpublished terms.	No change
Somalia	A smartphone financing programme launched in May 2026, against about 50 per cent of the operator's base still on feature phones and fourth-generation coverage above 70 per cent. Full record The programme was launched by the dominant operator with a financing partner (programme). About half the operator's base still used feature phones against coverage above 70 per cent (devices), so the constraint is the device rather than the network — the same diagnosis several other units in this frame reach and few act on. No price, term, interest rate or uptake figure is published.	Advanced
South Africa	Households with no telephone fell to 3.7% in 2025 from nearly 55% in 2002 (figures), while the zero-rating obligation runs late (acknowledgement). Full record The share of households with no telephone at all fell from nearly 55% in 2002 to 3.7% — about 740,000 households — in 2025, with 93.8% holding a cellphone only and 2.5% holding both a cellphone and a landline (figures). The communications minister acknowledged on 27 August 2026 that the zero-rating of public-benefit websites owed under the 2022 spectrum auction is moving slowly, five months before its deadline, while saying he remains confident it will be met (acknowledgement). Device access and affordable access are different problems, and the base's evidence now separates them: near-universal handset ownership alongside an unmet obligation to make public-interest content free to reach.	Mixed, household telephone access is now near-universal while the zero-rating obligation owed since 2022 is running late
South Sudan	A US\$67 million regional integration project carries the connectivity programme, alongside a 2,400 kilometre backbone and solar power for 500 network sites. Full record The regional digital integration project, at US\$67 million, is the active programme addressing connectivity and the digital divide through broadband fibre deployment (mission). The telecommunications undersecretary announced a 2,400 kilometre national backbone connecting to Kenya, intended to shift the country from expensive satellite connectivity toward terrestrial broadband reaching rural areas (backbone), and a follow-on US\$5 million investment, US\$10 million in total, financed solar-hybrid power for over 500 mobile network sites, improving reliability in areas without stable electricity (power). Every instrument here is external. None is financed domestically, and the usage divide they address is not measured.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sudan	Connectivity assessments began in two Darfur hotspots in February 2026, with satellite services sought and equipment moved. Full record The emergency telecommunications cluster began connectivity assessments from 1 February 2026 in Tawila in North Darfur and Geneina in West Darfur, two of the most critical humanitarian locations (report). The same report records authorisation sought from the foreign ministry to extend satellite-phone services through 2026 and to pilot satellite internet devices and push-to-talk units, and three tonnes of telecommunications equipment moved. The divide these address is not measured: the only national usage figure is a commercial estimate of 28.7 per cent penetration (estimate), with no subnational breakdown on the base.	Advanced
Tanzania	A 758-tower rural project reported progress to Parliament with no count completed against the plan, 758 towers were handed to government, and 133 universal-service sites were completed. Full record The tower project's figures are the ministry's own, with no count of towers completed against the 758 planned and no measure of service uptake in the connected villages (project). An operator handed 758 towers and fibre to government in April 2026 (handover, sector), and a further 636-mast programme is due in March 2027 with no cost, financier or completion date stated (masts). The universal service fund completed 133 sites; no levy rate, fund balance, appropriation or programme-wide site target is held anywhere in the base, so the fund is named and never quantified (fund).	Advanced
Togo	A community network to connect 2,000 inhabitants was announced as imminent in May 2025, as a response to the absence of traditional operator coverage. Full record It was stated by an internet society chapter as a response to the absence of operator coverage (network). Nothing since. A single village-scale community network, announced fifteen months ago and unmoved, is the whole of the divide-bridging record for this country — against a universal-service instrument that appears nowhere in the ledger.	No change
Uganda	The universal service fund retains half the statutory levy with no balance published, and the six-year rural inclusion programme closed reporting 3.4m registered users but only about 29 per cent active. Full record An operator remitted UGX 20.9bn at a handover ceremony; half the statutory 2 per cent levy goes to the consolidated fund and only half is retained, no fund balance or annual total is published, and the statutory basis is a named section of the 2013 communications Act (fund, contribution, remittance). The foreign agency's withdrawal cut 83 per cent of its programmes (withdrawal); a multi-funder digital-economy fund lost its American component while the parts other funders backed continued, and no figure for the national share is stated (withdrawal). Border free public wireless access was launched two weeks before the window opened (border). The US\$15m Swedish-funded rural inclusion programme closed on a 2019-2025 term, and its close-out is the only outcome record held for it: more than 3.4 million registered users of whom about 29 per cent were active, more than 21,000 agents recruited, 26 services piloted, and its own statement that technology alone could not close the usage gap (close-out, closure). No successor is on file, and registration counts what a programme reached, not what it changed.	Regressed

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Zambia	The Universal Access and Service Fund has no fund size, levy rate, annual disbursement or cumulative tower count held for any year, under 2012 regulations that are its regulatory basis. Full record A board assessment tour of projects in three provinces took place in 2026, and no fund size, levy rate, annual disbursement or cumulative tower count is held for any year (fund, projects, bill). The regulations were gazetted in June 2012 and are the fund's regulatory basis; the fund's own size, current levy collected and annual disbursement remain not held (regulations). Fourteen years of a universal access fund with no published financial figure of any kind is the single largest accountability gap in this ledger.	No change
Zimbabwe	The universal services fund is vested in the regulator as trustee with no balance or annual disbursement published in the Auditor-General's 2024 report, and its subscription support covers digital centres and schools only. Full record Contribution rates are set by statutory instrument and the Auditor-General's 2024 report publishes no balance (levy, regulations, amendment, scope). Subscription support covers digital centres and schools, with a further unquantified share committed to artificial-intelligence projects (support) – which is the fund being asked to finance the artificial-intelligence strategy's institutions as well as connectivity. A tower relocation programme is funded from the same fund (towers), and rural network population coverage comes from the regulator's fourth-quarter 2025 report (coverage).	No change

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